

Dr.B Townsed

The Emergency Department

Newtown Children Hospital

10/04/2010

Dear Dr. Townsed,

Re:Emma Johnson

I am writing to urgently refer Emma, an 11-year-old girl, whose symptoms and signs are consistent with severe asthma. Your expert assessment would be valued.

Today, Emma presented at my clinic with worsening shortness of breath and obvious use of the accessory muscles. She has had wheezing over the previous two days and fever, along with runny nose. Additionally, loss of appetite was reported. Her chest auscultation revealed a widespread wheeze with no focal signs, and the PEFR has markedly diminished to 140 l/min. Nebulized Ventolin has showed minimal improvement in her condition.

Initially, on 30/11/2009, Emma presented complaining of a nocturnal cough, which had worsened over the following weeks. Consequently, diagnosis of asthma was suggested. I commenced her on Ventolin, which slightly improved her symptoms. Her PEFR increased from 230 to 280 l/min. Inhaled corticosteroid was added as her asthma was still unstable.

Two months earlier, Emma's condition was stable. Her asthma was well-controlled on Becotide 200 two puffs three times per day and Ventolin, when needed. Her PEFR was 340 l/min.

Emma has no known allergies, and her mother as well as older sister are asthmatic.

I would be grateful if you could manage Emma's condition. Should there be any queries, kindly do not hesitate to contact me.

Yours sincerely,

Doctor